

ChatGPT: Everything you need to know about the AI-powered chatbot

ChatGPT, OpenAI's text-generating AI chatbot, has taken the world by storm since its launch [in November 2022](#). What started as a tool to supercharge productivity through writing essays and code with [short text prompts](#) has evolved into a behemoth with [300 million weekly active users](#).

2024 was a big year for OpenAI, from its [partnership with Apple](#) for its generative AI offering, [Apple Intelligence](#), the release of [GPT-4o with voice capabilities](#), and the highly-anticipated launch of its [text-to-video model Sora](#).

OpenAI also faced its share of internal drama, including the notable exits of high-level execs like co-founder and [longtime chief scientist Ilya Sutskever](#) and [CTO Mira Murati](#). OpenAI has also been hit with lawsuits from [Alden Global Capital-owned newspapers](#) alleging copyright infringement, as well as [an injunction from Elon Musk](#) to halt OpenAI's transition to a for-profit.

In 2025, OpenAI is battling the perception that it's ceding ground in the AI race to [Chinese rivals like DeepSeek](#). The company has been trying to shore up its [relationship with Washington](#) as it simultaneously [pursues an ambitious data center project](#), and as it [reportedly lays the groundwork](#) for one of the largest funding rounds in history.

Below, you'll find a timeline of ChatGPT product updates and releases, starting with the latest, which we've been updating throughout the year. If you have any other questions, check out [our ChatGPT FAQ here](#).

To see a list of 2024 updates, [go here](#).

Timeline of the most recent ChatGPT updates

- June 2025
- [May 2025](#)
- [April 2025](#)
- [March 2025](#)
- [February 2025](#)
- [January 2025](#)
- [ChatGPT FAQs](#)

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June 2025

OpenAI uses Google's AI chips to power its products

OpenAI has started using [Google's AI chips to power ChatGPT](#) and other products, as reported by Reuters. The ChatGPT maker is one of the biggest buyers of Nvidia's GPUs, using the AI chips to train models, and this is the first time that OpenAI is using *non*-Nvidia chips in an important way.

A new MIT study suggests that ChatGPT might be harming critical thinking skills

[Researchers from MIT's Media Lab monitored](#) the brain activity of writers in 32 regions. They found that ChatGPT users showed minimal brain engagement and consistently fell short in neural, linguistic, and behavioral aspects. To conduct the test, the lab split 54 participants from the Boston area into three groups, each consisting of individuals ages 18 to 39. The participants were asked to write multiple SAT essays using tools such as OpenAI's ChatGPT, the Google search engine, or without any tools.

ChatGPT was downloaded 30 million times last month

The ChatGPT app for iOS was downloaded 29.6 million times in the last 28 days, while TikTok, Facebook, Instagram, and X were downloaded a total of 32.9 million times during the same period, representing a difference of about 10.6%, according to [ZDNET report](#) citing Similarweb's X post.

The energy needed for an average ChatGPT query can power a lightbulb for a couple of minutes

Sam Altman said that the average ChatGPT query uses about one-fifteenth of a teaspoon of water, equivalent to 0.000083 gallons of water, or the energy required to power a lightbulb for a few minutes, [per Business Insider](#). In addition to that, the chatbot requires 0.34 watt-hours of electricity to operate.

OpenAI has launched o3-pro, an upgraded version of its o3 AI reasoning model

OpenAI [has unveiled o3-pro](#), an enhanced version of its o3, a reasoning model that the chatGPT maker launched earlier this year. O3-pro is available for ChatGPT and Team users and in the API, while Enterprise and Edu users will get access in the third week of June.



OpenAI  · Jun 11, 2025



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OpenAI o3-pro has access to tools that make ChatGPT useful—it can search the web, analyze files, reason about visual inputs, use Python, personalize responses using memory, and more.



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OpenAI o3-pro is available in the model picker for Pro and Team users starting today, replacing OpenAI o1-pro.

Enterprise and Edu users will get access the week after.

As o3-pro uses the same underlying model as o3, full safety details can be found in the o3 system card. [Show more](#)

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709



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ChatGPT's conversational voice mode has been upgraded

OpenAI [upgraded ChatGPT's conversational voice mood](#) for all paid users across different markets and platforms. The startup has launched an update to Advanced Voice that enables users to converse with ChatGPT out loud in a more natural and fluid sound. The feature also helps users translate languages more easily, the company [said](#).

ChatGPT has added new features like meeting recording and connectors for Google Drive, Box, and more

OpenAI's ChatGPT [now offers new functions for business users](#), including integrations with various cloud services, meeting recordings, and MCP connection support for connecting to tools for in-depth research. The feature enables ChatGPT to retrieve information across users' own services to answer their questions. For instance, an analyst could use the company's slide deck and documents to develop an investment thesis.

May 2025

OpenAI CFO says hardware will drive ChatGPT's growth

OpenAI [plans to purchase Jony Ive's devices startup io](#) for \$6.4 billion. Sarah Friar, CFO of OpenAI, [thinks that the hardware will significantly enhance](#) ChatGPT and broaden OpenAI's reach to a larger audience in the future.

OpenAI's ChatGPT unveils its AI coding agent, Codex

OpenAI [has introduced its AI coding agent, Codex](#), powered by codex-1, a version of [its o3 AI reasoning model](#) designed for software engineering tasks. OpenAI says codex-1 generates more precise and “cleaner” code than o3. The coding agent may take anywhere from one to 30 minutes to complete tasks such as writing simple features, fixing bugs, answering questions about your codebase, and running tests.

Sam Altman aims to make ChatGPT more personalized by tracking every aspect of a person's life

Sam Altman, the CEO of OpenAI, said during a recent AI event hosted by VC firm Sequoia that [he wants ChatGPT to record and remember every detail of a person's life](#) when one attendee asked about how ChatGPT can become more personalized.

OpenAI releases its GPT-4.1 and GPT-4.1 mini AI models in ChatGPT

OpenAI said in [a post on X](#) that it [has launched its GPT-4.1 and GPT4.1 mini AI](#) models in ChagGPT.



ChatGPT deep research now connects with GitHub (in beta) to answer code-related questions

OpenAI [has launched a new feature](#) for [ChatGPT deep research](#) to analyze code repositories on GitHub. The ChatGPT deep research feature is in beta and lets developers connect with GitHub to ask questions about codebases and engineering documents. The connector will soon be available for ChatGPT Plus, Pro, and Team users, with support for Enterprise and Education coming shortly, per an OpenAI spokesperson.

OpenAI launches a new data residency program in Asia

After introducing [a data residency program in Europe](#) in February, [OpenAI has now launched](#) a similar program [in Asian countries](#) including India, Japan, Singapore, and South Korea. The new program will be accessible to users of ChatGPT Enterprise, ChatGPT Edu, and API. It will help organizations in Asia meet their local data sovereignty requirements when using OpenAI's products.

OpenAI to introduce a program to grow AI infrastructure

[OpenAI is unveiling a program](#) called [OpenAI for Countries](#), which aims to develop the necessary local infrastructure to serve international AI clients better. The AI startup will work with governments to assist with increasing data center capacity and customizing OpenAI's products to meet specific language and local needs. OpenAI for Countries is part of efforts to support the company's expansion of its AI data center Project Stargate to new locations outside the U.S., per [Bloomberg](#).

OpenAI promises to make changes to prevent future ChatGPT sycophancy

OpenAI [has announced](#) its plan to [make changes to its procedures for updating the AI models](#) that power ChatGPT, [following an update](#) that caused the platform to become [overly sycophantic](#) for many users.

April 2025

OpenAI clarifies the reason ChatGPT became overly flattering and agreeable

OpenAI [has released a post](#) on the recent sycophancy issues with the default AI model powering ChatGPT, GPT-4o, leading the company to revert an update to the model released last week. CEO Sam Altman acknowledged the issue on Sunday and confirmed two days later that the [GPT-4o update was being rolled back](#). OpenAI is working on “additional fixes” to the model’s personality. Over the weekend, users on social media criticized the new model for making ChatGPT too validating and agreeable. It became a popular meme fast.

OpenAI is working to fix a “bug” that let minors engage in inappropriate conversations

An issue within OpenAI’s ChatGPT enabled the chatbot to create graphic erotic content for accounts registered by users under the age of 18, as demonstrated by [TechCrunch’s testing](#), a fact later confirmed by OpenAI. “Protecting younger users is a top priority, and our Model Spec, which guides model behavior, clearly restricts sensitive content like erotica to narrow contexts such as scientific, historical, or news reporting,” a spokesperson told TechCrunch via email. “In this case, a bug allowed responses outside those guidelines, and we are actively deploying a fix to limit these generations.”

ChatGPT helps users by giving recommendations, showing images, and reviewing products for online shopping

OpenAI [has added a few features to](#) its [ChatGPT search](#), its web search tool in ChatGPT, to give users an improved online shopping experience. The company says people can ask super-specific questions using natural language and receive customized results. The chatbot provides recommendations, images, and reviews of products in various categories such as fashion, beauty, home goods, and electronics.

OpenAI wants its AI model to access cloud models for assistance

OpenAI leaders have been talking about allowing the open model to link up with OpenAI’s cloud-hosted models to improve its ability to respond to intricate questions, [two sources familiar with the situation told TechCrunch](#).

OpenAI aims to make its new “open” AI model the best on the market

OpenAI [is preparing to launch an AI system](#) that will be openly accessible, allowing users to download it for free without any API restrictions. Aidan Clark, OpenAI’s VP of research, is spearheading the development of the open model, which is in the very early stages, sources familiar with the situation told TechCrunch.

OpenAI’s GPT-4.1 may be less aligned than earlier models

OpenAI released a new AI model called GPT-4.1 in mid-April. However, multiple independent tests indicate that the model is less reliable than previous OpenAI releases. The company [skipped that step](#) — sending safety cards for GPT-4.1 — claiming in a statement to TechCrunch that “GPT-4.1 is not a frontier model, so there won’t be a separate system card released for it.”

OpenAI’s o3 AI model scored lower than expected on a benchmark

Questions have been raised regarding OpenAI’s transparency and procedures for testing models after a [difference in benchmark outcomes](#) was detected by first- and third-party benchmark results

for the o3 AI model. OpenAI introduced o3 in December, stating that the model could solve approximately 25% of questions on FrontierMath, a difficult math problem set. Epoch AI, the research institute behind FrontierMath, discovered that o3 achieved a score of approximately 10%, which was significantly lower than OpenAI's top-reported score.

OpenAI unveils Flex processing for cheaper, slower AI tasks

OpenAI has launched [a new API feature called Flex processing](#) that allows users to use AI models at a lower cost but with slower response times and occasional resource unavailability. Flex processing is available in beta on the o3 and o4-mini reasoning models for non-production tasks like model evaluations, data enrichment, and asynchronous workloads.

OpenAI's latest AI models now have a safeguard against biorisks

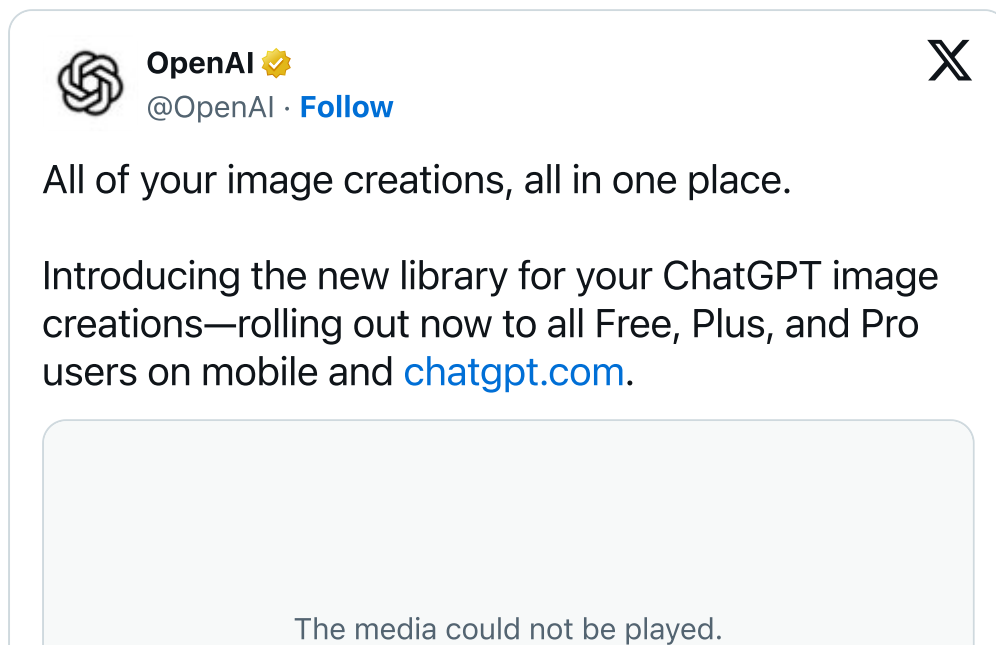
OpenAI has rolled out a new system to monitor its [AI reasoning models, o3 and o4 mini](#), for biological and chemical threats. The system is designed to prevent models from giving advice that could potentially lead to harmful attacks, as stated in [OpenAI's safety report](#).

OpenAI launches its latest reasoning models, o3 and o4-mini

OpenAI [has released two new reasoning models](#), o3 and o4 mini, just two days after launching GPT-4.1. The company claims o3 is the most advanced reasoning model it has developed, while o4-mini is said to provide a balance of price, speed, and performance. The new models stand out from previous reasoning models because they can use ChatGPT features like web browsing, coding, and image processing and generation. But [they hallucinate](#) more than several of OpenAI's previous models.

OpenAI has added a new section to ChatGPT to offer easier access to AI-generated images for all user tiers

Open AI introduced a new section called "library" to make it easier for users to create images on mobile and web platforms, per [the company's X post](#).



OpenAI could “adjust” its safeguards if rivals release “high-risk” AI

[OpenAI said on Tuesday](#) that it might revise its safety standards if “another frontier AI developer releases a high-risk system without comparable safeguards.” The move shows how commercial AI developers face more pressure to rapidly implement models due to the increased competition.

OpenAI is building its own social media network

OpenAI [is currently in the early stages of developing](#) its own social media platform to compete with Elon Musk's X and Mark Zuckerberg's Instagram and Threads, [according to The Verge](#). It is unclear whether OpenAI intends to launch the social network as a standalone application or incorporate it into ChatGPT.

OpenAI will remove its largest AI model, GPT-4.5, from the API, in July

OpenAI [will discontinue its largest AI model, GPT-4.5](#), from its API even though it was just launched in late February. GPT-4.5 will be available in a research preview for paying customers. Developers can use GPT-4.5 through OpenAI's API until July 14; then, they will need to switch to GPT-4.1, which was released on April 14.

OpenAI unveils GPT-4.1 AI models that focus on coding capabilities

OpenAI [has launched three members of the GPT-4.1 model](#) — GPT-4.1, GPT-4.1 mini, and GPT-4.1 nano — with a specific focus on coding capabilities. It's accessible via the OpenAI API but not ChatGPT. In the competition to develop advanced programming models, GPT-4.1 will rival AI models such as [Google's Gemini 2.5 Pro](#), [Anthropic's Claude 3.7 Sonnet](#), and [DeepSeek's upgraded V3](#).

OpenAI will discontinue ChatGPT's GPT-4 at the end of April

OpenAI [plans to sunset GPT-4](#), an AI model introduced more than two years ago, and replace it with GPT-4o, the current default model, [per changelog](#). It will take effect on April 30. GPT-4 will remain available via OpenAI's API.

OpenAI could release GPT-4.1 soon

OpenAI may launch several new AI models, including GPT-4.1, soon, The Verge [reported](#), citing anonymous sources. GPT-4.1 would be an update of OpenAI's GPT-4o, which was released last year. On the list of upcoming models are GPT-4.1 and smaller versions like GPT-4.1 mini and nano, per the report.

OpenAI has updated ChatGPT to use information from your previous conversations

OpenAI [started updating ChatGPT](#) to enable the chatbot to remember previous conversations with a user and customize its responses based on that context. This feature is rolling out to ChatGPT Pro and Plus users first, excluding those in the U.K., EU, Iceland, Liechtenstein, Norway, and Switzerland.

OpenAI is working on watermarks for images made with ChatGPT

It looks like OpenAI is working on a watermarking feature for images generated using GPT-4o. AI researcher Tibor Blaho [spotted](#) a new "ImageGen" watermark feature in the new beta of ChatGPT's Android app. Blaho also found mentions of other tools: "Structured Thoughts," "Reasoning Recap," "CoT Search Tool," and "1239dk1."

OpenAI offers ChatGPT Plus for free to U.S., Canadian college students

OpenAI is offering its \$20-per-month [ChatGPT Plus](#) subscription tier for free to all college students [in the U.S. and Canada through the end of May](#). The offer will let millions of students use OpenAI's premium service, which offers access to the company's GPT-4o model, image generation, voice interaction, and research tools that are not available in the free version.

ChatGPT users have generated over 700M images so far

More than 130 million users have created over 700 million images since ChatGPT got [the upgraded image generator](#) on March 25, according to [COO of OpenAI Brad Lightcap](#). The image generator was made available [to all ChatGPT users](#) on March 31, and went viral for being able to create Ghibli-style photos.

OpenAI's o3 model could cost more to run than initial estimate

The Arc Prize Foundation, which develops the AI benchmark tool ARC-AGI, has updated the estimated computing costs for OpenAI's o3 "reasoning" model managed by ARC-AGI. The organization originally estimated that the best-performing configuration of o3 it tested, o3 high, would cost approximately \$3,000 to address a single problem. The Foundation now thinks the cost could be much higher, [possibly around \\$30,000 per task](#).

OpenAI CEO says capacity issues will cause product delays

In a [series](#) of posts [on X](#), OpenAI CEO Sam Altman said the company's new image-generation tool's popularity may cause product releases to be delayed. "We are getting things under control, but you should expect new releases from OpenAI to be delayed, stuff to break, and for service to sometimes be slow as we deal with capacity challenges," he wrote.

March 2025

OpenAI plans to release a new 'open' AI language model

OpenAI [intends to release its "first" open language model](#) since [GPT-2](#) "in the coming months." The company plans to host developer events to gather feedback and eventually showcase prototypes of the model. The first developer event is to be held in San Francisco, with sessions to follow in Europe and Asia.

OpenAI removes ChatGPT's restrictions on image generation

OpenAI [made a notable change to its content moderation policies](#) after the success of its new image generator in ChatGPT, which went viral for being able to create [Studio Ghibli-style images](#). The company has updated its policies to allow ChatGPT to generate images of public figures, hateful symbols, and racial features when requested. OpenAI had previously declined such prompts due to the potential controversy or harm they may cause. However, the company has now "evolved" its approach, as stated [in a blog post](#) published by Joanne Jang, the lead for OpenAI's model behavior.

OpenAI adopts Anthropic's standard for linking AI models with data

OpenAI [wants to incorporate Anthropic's Model Context Protocol \(MCP\)](#) into all of its products, including the ChatGPT desktop app. MCP, an open-source standard, helps AI models generate more accurate and suitable responses to specific queries, and lets developers create bidirectional links between data sources and AI applications like chatbots. The protocol is currently available in the Agents SDK, and support for the ChatGPT desktop app and Responses API will be coming soon, OpenAI CEO [Sam Altman said](#).

OpenAI's viral Studio Ghibli-style images could raise AI copyright concerns

[The latest update of the image generator on OpenAI's ChatGPT](#) has triggered a flood of AI-generated memes in the style of Studio Ghibli, the Japanese animation studio behind blockbuster films like "My Neighbor Totoro" and "Spirited Away." The burgeoning mass of Ghibli-esque images have [sparked concerns about](#) whether OpenAI has violated copyright laws, especially since the company is already facing legal action for using source material without authorization.

OpenAI expects revenue to triple to \$12.7 billion this year

OpenAI expects its revenue to triple to \$12.7 billion in 2025, fueled by the performance of its paid AI software, Bloomberg [reported](#), citing an anonymous source. While the startup doesn't expect to reach positive cash flow until 2029, it expects revenue to increase significantly in 2026 to surpass \$29.4 billion, the report said.

ChatGPT has upgraded its image-generation feature

OpenAI on [Tuesday](#) rolled out a major upgrade to ChatGPT's image-generation capabilities: ChatGPT can now use [the GPT-4o](#) model to generate and edit images and photos directly. The feature went live earlier this week in ChatGPT and Sora, OpenAI's AI video-generation tool, for subscribers of the company's Pro plan, priced at \$200 a month, and will be available soon to ChatGPT Plus subscribers and developers using the company's API service. The company's CEO [Sam Altman said on Wednesday](#), however, that the release of the image generation feature to free users would be delayed due to higher demand than the company expected.

OpenAI announces leadership updates

Brad Lightcap, OpenAI's chief operating officer, will lead the company's global expansion and manage corporate partnerships [as CEO Sam Altman shifts his focus to research and products](#), according [to a blog post](#) from OpenAI. Lightcap, who previously worked with Altman at Y Combinator, joined the Microsoft-backed startup in 2018. OpenAI also said Mark Chen would step into the expanded role of chief research officer, and Julia Villagra will take on the role of chief people officer.

OpenAI's AI voice assistant now has advanced feature

[OpenAI](#) has updated its AI voice assistant with improved chatting capabilities, according to a video posted on Monday (March 24) to the company's [official media channels](#). The update enables real-time conversations, and the AI assistant is said to be more personable and interrupts users less often. Users on ChatGPT's free tier can now access the new version of Advanced Voice Mode, while paying users will receive answers that are "more direct, engaging, concise, specific, and creative," [a spokesperson from OpenAI told TechCrunch](#).

OpenAI, Meta in talks with Reliance in India

OpenAI and Meta have separately engaged in discussions with Indian conglomerate Reliance Industries regarding potential collaborations to enhance their AI services in the country, [per a report by The Information](#). One key topic being discussed is Reliance Jio distributing OpenAI's ChatGPT. Reliance has proposed selling OpenAI's models to businesses in India through an application programming interface (API) so they can incorporate AI into their operations. Meta also plans to bolster its presence in India by constructing a large 3GW data center in Jamnagar, Gujarat. OpenAI, Meta, and Reliance have not yet officially announced these plans.

OpenAI faces privacy complaint in Europe for chatbot's defamatory hallucinations

Noyb, a privacy rights advocacy group, is supporting an individual in Norway [who was shocked to discover that ChatGPT](#) was providing false information about him, stating that he had been found guilty of killing two of his children and trying to harm the third. "The GDPR is clear. Personal data has to be accurate," said Joakim Söderberg, data protection lawyer at Noyb, in a statement. "If it's not, users have the right to have it changed to reflect the truth. Showing ChatGPT users a tiny disclaimer that the chatbot can make mistakes clearly isn't enough. You can't just spread false information and in the end add a small disclaimer saying that everything you said may just not be true."

OpenAI upgrades its transcription and voice-generating AI models

OpenAI [has added new transcription and voice-generating AI models to its APIs](#): a text-to-speech model, "gpt-4o-mini-tts," that delivers more nuanced and realistic sounding speech, as well as two speech-to-text models called "gpt-4o-transcribe" and "gpt-4o-mini-transcribe". The company claims they are improved versions of what was already there and that they hallucinate less.

OpenAI has launched o1-pro, a more powerful version of its o1

[OpenAI has introduced o1-pro](#) in its developer API. OpenAI says its o1-pro uses more computing than its [o1 "reasoning" AI model](#) to deliver "consistently better responses." It's only accessible to select developers who have spent at least \$5 on OpenAI API services. OpenAI charges \$150 for every million tokens (about 750,000 words) input into the model and \$600 for every million tokens the model produces. It costs twice as much as [OpenAI's GPT-4.5](#) for input and 10 times the price of regular o1.

OpenAI research lead Noam Brown thinks AI “reasoning” models could’ve arrived decades ago

Noam Brown, who heads AI reasoning research at OpenAI, [thinks that certain types of AI models for “reasoning” could have been developed 20 years ago](#) if researchers had understood the correct approach and algorithms.

OpenAI says it has trained an AI that’s “really good” at creative writing

OpenAI CEO Sam Altman said, in a [post on X](#), that the company has [trained a “new model” that’s “really good” at creative writing](#). He posted a lengthy sample from the model given the prompt “Please write a metafictional literary short story about AI and grief.” OpenAI has not extensively explored the use of AI for writing fiction. The company has mostly concentrated on challenges in rigid, predictable areas such as math and programming. And it turns out that it [might not be that great](#) at creative writing at all.



Sam Altman  
@sama · [Follow](#)



we trained a new model that is good at creative writing (not sure yet how/when it will get released). this is the first time i have been really struck by something written by AI; it got the vibe of metafiction so right.

PROMPT:

Please write a metafictional literary short story [Show more](#)

11:58 PM · Mar 11, 2025 

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OpenAI launches new tools to help businesses build AI agents

OpenAI [rolled out new tools](#) designed [to help developers and businesses build AI agents](#) — automated systems that can independently accomplish tasks — using the company’s own AI models and frameworks. The tools are part of OpenAI’s new Responses API, which enables enterprises to develop customized AI agents that can perform web searches, scan through company files, and navigate websites, similar to [OpenAI’s Operator product](#). The Responses API effectively replaces [OpenAI’s Assistants API](#), which the company plans to discontinue in the first half of 2026.

OpenAI reportedly plans to charge up to \$20,000 a month for specialized AI ‘agents’

OpenAI [intends to release several “agent” products](#) tailored for different applications, including sorting and ranking sales leads and software engineering, according to [a report from The Information](#). One, a “high-income knowledge worker” agent, will reportedly be priced at \$2,000 a month. Another, a software developer agent, is said to cost \$10,000 a month. The most expensive rumored agents, which are said to be aimed at supporting “PhD-level research,” are expected to cost \$20,000 per month. The jaw-dropping figure is indicative of how much cash OpenAI needs right now: The company lost roughly \$5 billion last year after paying for costs related to running its services and other expenses. It’s unclear when these agentic tools might launch or which customers will be eligible to buy them.

ChatGPT can directly edit your code

The latest version of the macOS ChatGPT app [allows users to edit code directly in supported developer tools](#), including Xcode, VS Code, and JetBrains. ChatGPT Plus, Pro, and Team subscribers can use the feature now, and the company plans to roll it out to more users like Enterprise, Edu, and free users.

ChatGPT's weekly active users doubled in less than 6 months, thanks to new releases

According to [a new report](#) from VC firm Andreessen Horowitz (a16z), OpenAI's AI chatbot, ChatGPT, [experienced solid growth in the second half of 2024](#). It took ChatGPT nine months to increase its weekly active users from [100 million in November 2023](#) to 200 million in August 2024, but it only took less than six months to double that number once more, according to the report. ChatGPT's weekly active users increased to [300 million by December 2024](#) and [400 million by February 2025](#). ChatGPT has experienced significant growth recently due to the launch of new models and features, such as GPT-4o, with multimodal capabilities. ChatGPT usage spiked from April to May 2024, shortly after that model's launch.

February 2025

OpenAI cancels its o3 AI model in favor of a 'unified' next-gen release

OpenAI has effectively canceled the release of o3 in favor of what CEO Sam Altman is calling a "simplified" product offering. In a [post on X](#), Altman said that, in the coming months, OpenAI will release a model called GPT-5 that "integrates a lot of [OpenAI's] technology," including o3, in ChatGPT and its API. As a result of that roadmap decision, OpenAI no longer plans to release o3 as a standalone model.

ChatGPT may not be as power-hungry as once assumed

A [commonly cited stat](#) is that ChatGPT requires around 3 watt-hours of power to answer a single question. Using OpenAI's latest default model for ChatGPT, GPT-4o, as a reference, nonprofit [AI research institute Epoch AI](#) found the average ChatGPT query [consumes around 0.3 watt-hours](#). However, the analysis doesn't consider the additional energy costs incurred by ChatGPT with features like image generation or input processing.

OpenAI now reveals more of its o3-mini model's thought process

In response to pressure from rivals like DeepSeek, OpenAI is changing the way its o3-mini model communicates [its step-by-step "thought" process](#). ChatGPT users will see an updated "chain of thought" that shows more of the model's "reasoning" steps and how it arrived at answers to questions.

You can now use ChatGPT web search without logging in

OpenAI is now allowing anyone to use ChatGPT web search [without having to log in](#). While OpenAI [had previously allowed](#) users to ask ChatGPT questions without signing in, responses were restricted to the chatbot's last training update. This only applies through ChatGPT.com, however. To use ChatGPT in any form through the native mobile app, you will still need to be logged in.

OpenAI unveils a new ChatGPT agent for 'deep research'

OpenAI announced a new AI "agent" [called deep research](#) that's designed to help people conduct in-depth, complex research using ChatGPT. OpenAI says the "agent" is intended for instances where you don't just want a quick answer or summary, but instead need to assiduously consider information from multiple websites and other sources.

January 2025

OpenAI used a subreddit to test AI persuasion

OpenAI used the subreddit r/ChangeMyView to [measure the persuasive abilities](#) of its AI reasoning models. OpenAI says it collects user [posts from the subreddit](#) and asks its AI models to write replies, in a closed environment, that would change the Reddit user's mind on a subject. The company then shows the responses to testers, who assess how persuasive the argument is, and finally OpenAI compares the AI models' responses to human replies for that same post.

OpenAI launches o3-mini, its latest 'reasoning' model

OpenAI launched a new [AI "reasoning" model, o3-mini](#), the newest in the company's o family of models. OpenAI first [previewed the model in December](#) alongside a more capable system called o3. OpenAI is pitching its new model as both "powerful" and "affordable."

ChatGPT's mobile users are 85% male, report says

A new report from app analytics firm Appfigures found that [over half of ChatGPT's mobile users](#) are under age 25, with users between ages 50 and 64 making up the second largest age demographic. The gender gap among ChatGPT users is even more significant. Appfigures estimates that across age groups, men make up 84.5% of all users.

OpenAI launches ChatGPT plan for US government agencies

OpenAI launched ChatGPT Gov [designed to provide U.S. government agencies](#) an additional way to access the tech. ChatGPT Gov includes many of the capabilities found in OpenAI's corporate-focused tier, ChatGPT Enterprise. OpenAI says that ChatGPT Gov enables agencies to more easily manage their own security, privacy, and compliance, and could expedite internal authorization of OpenAI's tools for the handling of non-public sensitive data.

More teens report using ChatGPT for schoolwork, despite the tech's faults

Younger Gen Zers are embracing ChatGPT, for schoolwork, [according to a new survey by the Pew Research Center](#). In a follow-up to its 2023 poll on ChatGPT usage among young people, Pew asked ~1,400 U.S.-based teens ages 13 to 17 whether they've used ChatGPT for homework or other school-related assignments. Twenty-six percent said that they had, double the number two years ago. Just over half of teens responding to the poll said they think it's acceptable to use ChatGPT for researching new subjects. But considering the ways ChatGPT can fall short, the results are possibly cause for alarm.

OpenAI says it may store deleted Operator data for up to 90 days

OpenAI says that it might store chats and associated screenshots from customers who use Operator, [the company's AI "agent" tool](#), for up to 90 days — even after a user manually deletes them. While OpenAI has a similar deleted data retention policy for ChatGPT, the retention period for ChatGPT is only 30 days, [which is 60 days shorter than Operator's](#).

OpenAI launches Operator, an AI agent that performs tasks autonomously

OpenAI is launching a research preview of Operator, a general-purpose AI agent that can [take control of a web browser and independently perform certain actions](#). Operator promises to automate tasks such as booking travel accommodations, making restaurant reservations, and shopping online.

OpenAI may preview its agent tool for users on the \$200-per-month Pro plan

Operator, [OpenAI's agent tool](#), could be released sooner rather than later. Changes to ChatGPT's code base suggest that [Operator will be available as an early research preview](#) to users on the \$200 Pro subscription plan. The changes aren't yet publicly visible, but [a user on X who goes by Choi](#) spotted these updates in ChatGPT's client-side code. TechCrunch separately identified the same references to Operator on OpenAI's website.

OpenAI tests phone number-only ChatGPT signups

OpenAI has begun testing a feature that lets new ChatGPT users [sign up with only a phone number](#) — no email required. The feature is currently in beta in the U.S. and India. However, users who create an account using their number can't upgrade to one of OpenAI's paid plans without verifying their account via an email. Multi-factor authentication also isn't supported without a valid email.

ChatGPT now lets you schedule reminders and recurring tasks

ChatGPT's new beta feature, called tasks, [allows users to set simple reminders](#). For example, you can ask ChatGPT to remind you when your passport expires in six months, and the AI assistant will follow up with a push notification on whatever platform you have tasks enabled. The feature will start rolling out to ChatGPT Plus, Team, and Pro users around the globe this week.

New ChatGPT feature lets users assign it traits like 'chatty' and 'Gen Z'

OpenAI is introducing a new way for users to [customize their interactions with ChatGPT](#). Some users found they can specify a preferred name or nickname and "traits" they'd like the chatbot to have. OpenAI suggests traits like "Chatty," "Encouraging," and "Gen Z." However, [some users reported](#) that the new options have disappeared, so it's possible they went live prematurely.

FAQs:

What is ChatGPT? How does it work?

ChatGPT is a general-purpose chatbot that uses artificial intelligence to generate text after a user enters a prompt, developed by tech startup [OpenAI](#). The chatbot uses GPT-4, a large language model that uses deep learning to produce human-like text.

When did ChatGPT get released?

November 30, 2022 is when ChatGPT was released for public use.

What is the latest version of ChatGPT?

Both the free version of ChatGPT and the paid ChatGPT Plus are regularly updated with new GPT models. The most recent model is [GPT-4o](#).

Can I use ChatGPT for free?

There is a free version of [ChatGPT](#) that only requires a sign-in in addition to the paid version, [ChatGPT Plus](#).

Who uses ChatGPT?

Anyone can use ChatGPT! More and more tech companies and [search engines](#) are utilizing the chatbot to automate text or quickly answer user questions/concerns.

What companies use ChatGPT?

Multiple enterprises utilize ChatGPT, although others may [limit the use of the AI-powered tool](#).

Most recently, [Microsoft announced](#) at its 2023 Build conference that it is integrating its ChatGPT-based Bing experience into Windows 11. A Brooklyn-based 3D display startup [Looking Glass utilizes ChatGPT](#) to produce holograms you can communicate with by using ChatGPT. And nonprofit organization [Solana officially integrated the chatbot](#) into its network with a ChatGPT plug-in geared toward end users to help onboard into the web3 space.

What does GPT mean in ChatGPT?

GPT stands for Generative Pre-Trained Transformer.

What is the difference between ChatGPT and a chatbot?

A chatbot can be any software/system that holds dialogue with you/a person but doesn't necessarily have to be AI-powered. For example, there are chatbots that are rules-based in the sense that they'll give canned responses to questions.

ChatGPT is AI-powered and utilizes LLM technology to generate text after a prompt.

Can ChatGPT write essays?

Yes.

Can ChatGPT commit libel?

[Due to the nature of how these models work](#), they don't know or care whether something is true, only that it looks true. That's a problem when you're using it to do your homework, sure, but when it accuses you of a crime you didn't commit, that may well at this point be libel.

We will see how [handling troubling statements produced by ChatGPT](#) will play out over the next few months as tech and legal experts attempt to tackle the fastest moving target in the industry.

Does ChatGPT have an app?

Yes, [there is a free ChatGPT mobile app](#) for iOS and Android users.

What is the ChatGPT character limit?

It's not documented anywhere that ChatGPT has a character limit. However, users have noted that there are some character limitations after around 500 words.

Does ChatGPT have an API?

Yes, it was [released](#) March 1, 2023.

What are some sample everyday uses for ChatGPT?

Everyday examples include programming, scripts, email replies, listicles, blog ideas, summarization, etc.

What are some advanced uses for ChatGPT?

Advanced use examples include debugging code, programming languages, scientific concepts, complex problem solving, etc.

How good is ChatGPT at writing code?

It depends on the nature of the program. While ChatGPT can write workable Python code, it can't necessarily program an entire app's worth of code. That's because ChatGPT lacks context awareness — in other words, the generated code isn't always appropriate for the specific context in which it's being used.

Can you save a ChatGPT chat?

Yes. OpenAI allows users to save chats in the ChatGPT interface, stored in the sidebar of the screen. There are no built-in sharing features yet.

Are there alternatives to ChatGPT?

Yes. There are [multiple AI-powered chatbot](#) competitors such as [Together](#), Google's [Gemini](#) and Anthropic's [Claude](#), and developers are [creating open source alternatives](#).

How does ChatGPT handle data privacy?

OpenAI has said that individuals in “certain jurisdictions” (such as the EU) can object to the processing of their personal information by its AI models by filling out [this form](#). This includes the ability to make requests for deletion of AI-generated references about you. Although OpenAI notes it may not grant every request since it must balance privacy requests against freedom of expression “in accordance with applicable laws”.

The web form for making a deletion of data about you request is entitled “[OpenAI Personal Data Removal Request](#)”.

In its privacy policy, the ChatGPT maker makes a passing acknowledgement of the objection requirements attached to relying on “legitimate interest” (LI), pointing users towards more information about requesting an opt out — when it writes: “See [here](#) for instructions on how you can opt out of our use of your information to train our models.”

What controversies have surrounded ChatGPT?

Recently, Discord announced that it had integrated OpenAI's technology into its bot named Clyde where [two users tricked Clyde into providing them with instructions for making the illegal drug methamphetamine](#) (meth) and the incendiary mixture napalm.

An Australian mayor has publicly announced [he may sue OpenAI for defamation](#) due to ChatGPT's false claims that he had served time in prison for bribery. This would be the first defamation lawsuit against the text-generating service.

CNET found itself in the midst of controversy after [Futurism reported](#) the publication was publishing articles under a mysterious byline completely generated by AI. The private equity company that owns CNET, Red Ventures, was [accused](#) of using ChatGPT for SEO farming, even if the information was incorrect.

Several major school systems and colleges, [including New York City Public Schools](#), have banned ChatGPT from their networks and devices. They claim that the AI impedes the learning process by promoting plagiarism and misinformation, a claim that [not every educator agrees with](#).

There have also been cases of ChatGPT [accusing individuals of false crimes](#).

Where can I find examples of ChatGPT prompts?

Several marketplaces host and provide ChatGPT prompts, either for free or for a nominal fee. One is [PromptBase](#). Another is [ChatX](#). More launch every day.

Can ChatGPT be detected?

Poorly. Several tools claim to detect ChatGPT-generated text, but in our [tests](#), they're inconsistent at best.

Are ChatGPT chats public?

No. But OpenAI [recently](#) disclosed a bug, since fixed, that exposed the titles of some users' conversations to other people on the service.

What lawsuits are there surrounding ChatGPT?

None specifically targeting ChatGPT. But OpenAI is [involved](#) in at least one lawsuit that has implications for AI systems trained on publicly available data, which would touch on ChatGPT.

Are there issues regarding plagiarism with ChatGPT?

Yes. Text-generating AI models like ChatGPT have a tendency to regurgitate content from their training data.

This story is continually updated with new information.

Topics

[AI](#), [ChatGPT](#), [evergreens](#), [Generative AI](#), [OpenAI](#)

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